

```
user 0m0.001s
sys 0m0.001s
```

— **Abhishek Tanwar**, abhishek.tanwar@gmail.com

A smart monitor for /proc

Sometimes, while working on a system with a heavy load, you need to monitor the processing and working load (or memory load) to ensure the uninterrupted operation of the system.

For this purpose, you need to monitor the `/proc` directory. But it's not so easy—you need to check every file to monitor their different status. Or you need to use commands like `$free`, `$nice`, etc. All this is very time consuming.

The command line tool `$procinfo` comes to the rescue here. With this, you can easily monitor and get different status reports of the system, such as:

1. Physical memory information
2. Boot-up timing
3. Average number of running jobs
4. Amount of time spent running jobs in each user space
5. Time spent running jobs in kernel space
6. Time spent running jobs in each user nice'd space
7. Swap-in and Swap-out status
8. Idle time
9. Number of times your hard disk is accessed
10. All available filesystems
11. Interrupt status
12. Character and block devices

Try `$procinfo -a` to know the status of all the above parameters and see the results.

— **Amit N. Bhakay**, amit.nb@gmail.com

Password-less log-ins

If you want to log in to any user account or even as the root, without entering a password, then follow these steps. Open the `/etc/passwd` file in your text editor and go to the following line:

```
root:x:0:0:root:/root:/bin/bash
```

Delete the second field (that is 'x') and save this file. You can also do this for other users as:

```
vik:x:500:500:vik:/home/vik:/bin/bash
```

Now reboot the system and try logging in without the user password.

— **Vikash Kumar Jha**, v4evervikash@gmail.com

Setting up an email alert when the root filesystem is almost full

When the root filesystem of your GNU/Linux systems is full, your system might stop working without any notification. So how will one know this might be the cause for the shutdown? Don't worry, there is a simple solution. The following command will show the amount of disk space used on the root partition:

```
# df / | grep / | awk '{ print $5 }'
```

Now you can create a script, which can be added to `crontab` and it will email you whenever the disk's free space drops to less than the critical amount, say 10 per cent. Here is a sample script:

```
#!/bin/bash
CURRENT=$(df / | grep / | awk '{ print $5 }' | sed 's/%/g')
THRESHOLD=90

if [ "$CURRENT" -gt "$THRESHOLD" ] ;
then

mail -s "Disk Space Alert" mail@domainname.com << EOF
Your root partition remaining space is critically low. Used:
$CURRENT%
EOF
fi
```

Now save this into a `sample.sh` file in your home directory and add the following line at the end of the `/etc/crontab` file:

```
@daily ~/sample.sh
```

That's it! Now whenever your root filesystem grows to beyond 90 per cent of the total partition size, you get a notification. So you can take the required steps to free up space before you reach the deadlock.

— **Mallikarjun**, mallik.v.arjun@gmail.com



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